

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 5
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K 9 3
♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ K 10 2
♥ K Q 9 8 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 6 3
♥ 7
♦ Q J 10 6
♣ J 10 7 2

♠ Q 9 4
♥ A J 6 3
♦ A 7 2
♣ K 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ Q			

only one ♠ trick, the ♠ A.

Assume East is on lead for the first ♠ play.

If he leads the ♠ A it sets up both the ♠ K and ♠ Q so you only have one ♠ loser. If he leads low you also play low from dummy and West must play the ♠ J to prevent you getting a trick with the ♠ 10. Again you only lose one ♠.

If West makes the first play by leading a low ♠ you play low from your hand. East must go up with the ♠ A to stop you from getting a trick with dummy's ♠ 9. Then your ♠ K and ♠ Q will win two tricks.

North is to play 4 ♥. East leads the ♦ Q.

You have two ♦ losers that you can't escape, as well as the ♠ A. So you must arrange your play so you don't lose a trick to the ♠ J. That could mean you will finesse one defender for that card, but it would be a lot better if you could make the defense play ♠s first.

There is no reason to hold up so take your ♦ A and pull trumps, West showing up with three of them.

Now eliminate ♣s by playing ♣ A, ♣ K, and ruffing a ♣.

The stage is now set for the throw-in. Be **SURE** to lead a ♦ for the throw-in, not a ♠.

The defense will win the ♦ and can then take another ♦ trick if they like. But then they will have to play a ♠ (or give you a ruff-sluff). And as long as they start the ♠s you are assured that you will lose

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5
 ♥ K Q J 10 8 4
 ♦ —
 ♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3

West	North	East	South
1♥	2♥	Pass	1♦
All Pass		Dbl	6♦
6♦ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

North's 2♥ bid showed a hand with limit raise or better in ♦s. South doesn't bother with Blackwood since he already knows about the Aces. He just bids the slam. South plays 6♦. West leads the ♥K, won by you with the ♥A.

The good news is that you have no losers in ♠s, ♥, or ♦s. The bad news is that you have two losers in ♣s. The good news is that missing the ♣KQ you could try two finesses. The bad news is that West overcalled, so he probably has both honors. The best news of all is that you know how to pull off an elimination play!. Play a trump to dummy's ♦K (West discards a ♥) and ruff the ♥5.

Pull the outstanding trump with the ♦A, then play ♠A, ♠K and ruff a ♠.

You want to play the first ♣ from dummy, so enter dummy with a trump.

Play the ♣10 from dummy and let it ride if East does not produce the ♣Q or ♣K. West will win with one of the honors but will have to return another ♣ or give you a ruff-sluff.

When you are missing the KQ of a suit, as in the ♣s on this hand, taking two finesses gives you a 75% chance of success - **all things being equal**.

In this case though, West's overcall means all things are not equal, so your chances are lower than 75%.

But never mind the percentages for a finesse, the end-play was a sure thing.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 9 8 2
 ♦ 10 8 7 6 2
 ♣ 5

♠ K 4
 ♥ K 10 3
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ A 10 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 8 7
 ♥ 6 5 4
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ K 4

♠ 9 3 2
 ♥ A J 7
 ♦ A 4
 ♣ Q J 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♠	2♠
Pass	3♣	Pass	5♣
All Pass			
5♣ by North			
Lead: ♠Q			

South's cue-bid shows a limit raise or better (11 points) in ♣s. North is to play 5♣. East leads the ♠Q, West takes the ♠A and returns the ♠6 to your ♠K.

You have lost one trick already and have a possible loser in trumps and another possible loser in ♥s. Both losers can be avoided with successful finesses. The problem with the ♣ finesse is that East made an overcall so he is more likely to hold the ♣K. If you don't try the ♣ finesse you may be able to throw a defender in with the ♣K at a time when he will have to help you with his next play.

After winning the ♠K immediately play the ♣A.

It would have been nice to see the ♣K fall, but it didn't. So play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A and play the ♠9, ruffing in your hand.

Eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦K, then ruffing your last ♦ in dummy.

You have done all the eliminating, time to throw in somebody. Play a ♣.

Whichever defender had the ♣K is now on lead, but wishes he wasn't. If he plays a ♥ you get a free finesse. If he plays anything else you get a ruff-sluff.

If you had finessed for the ♣K East would have won the trick and been able to make a safe exit, probably with his other ♣.

You would then have been forced to rely on the ♥ finesse, and with East being the defender who showed some strength, you would likely have finessed through him.

About the only way the elimination/throw-in could fail is if the ♣s split 3-0. Then, if you play Ace and another the defender who wins would use his third ♣ as a safe exit.

Board 4

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

West

Pass

Pass

Pass

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

North

1NT

4♥

6♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

3♥

5♣

Your 3♥ bid is a slam suggestion. After you show the ♣A partner wastes no time in bidding it.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠K.

This is a good slam. You have only two possible ♣ losers, and by taking two ♣ finesses you have an excellent chance of success. But by using an elimination play you will have a sure thing.

Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with a ♥ honor.

Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9 and ruff another ♠. Both defenders followed to the trump play.

Play another ♥ to dummy's ♥10 and ruff the last ♠.

Play the ♦A and ♦K.

Conveniently in dummy, you play a ♣ and insert the ♣10 if East plays low.

West will probably win this trick. If he wins with the ♣K then your hand is good. If he wins with the ♣J then he is end-played, forced to either lead a ♣ into your ♣A Q or to give you a ruff-sluff.

You probably noticed that you could have finessed your ♣Q on the first ♣ play and pulled off the end-play just as effectively. But there is an advantage to making the first finesse with the ♣10.

If East just happens to hold both the ♣K and ♣J you will make all thirteen tricks if your first finesse is with the ♣10!